INDEPENDENT PRODUCT METRICS EXERCISE

YouTube: Defining Product Success

Product metrics case study · Fathima Babuji

CONTEXT

An independent exercise in choosing metrics for a product I do not work on. It is not affiliated with YouTube and uses no internal data.

PROBLEM

Raw watch time can rise through low-quality or addictive content, so it is a risky single goal.

DECISION

North Star: meaningful watch sessions per active user.
Supporting metrics: 7-day and 28-day retention, and creator success (satisfied supply rate).

GUARDRAILS

- Negative feedback and “not interested” signals
- Policy violation rates
- Recommendation diversity and creator concentration
- Session abandonment

EXPERIMENT EXAMPLE

Test a ranking improvement on a defined cohort.

- **Primary:** meaningful watch sessions
- **Secondary:** retention and satisfaction
- **Stop if** guardrails regress